

AI Advice Generation

To generate the AI forecasts, each photograph was uploaded to ChatGPT along with the following prompt:

I want to estimate the age of the person in the photograph.

The estimate should be just a number (in years), and nothing else.

That should be followed by your reasoning and explanation of your estimate.

Give me your answer in this exact format:

"number" (this should be your age estimate)

"text" (this should be a two-sentence explanation of your estimate)

To ensure no unintended ordering effects in advice generation that might affect the standalone accuracy of the AI advice, we recorded the predictions using ChatGPT's Temporary Chat feature. This feature ensures that the AI engine is not aware of previous conversations and cannot access memories, and therefore is not affected by prompts or responses provided earlier in sequence

In the Baseline condition, we used GPT-4's exact prediction on the i -th task as AI advice $BaselineAdvice_i$. We generated the new AI advice in the Worse Advice treatment as $WorseAdvice_i = \lfloor BaselineAdvice_i \cdot Z_i \rfloor$ and the new AI advice in the Better Advice treatment as $BetterAdvice_i = \left\lfloor \frac{4}{5} BaselineAdvice_i + \frac{1}{5} TrueValue_i \right\rfloor$, where $Z_i \sim Uni[0.7, 1.3]$ and the notation $\lfloor \cdot \rfloor$ implies rounding off to the nearest integer. For both treatments, the textual advice had to be modified minimally in some cases in order to keep it consistent with the numeric value of the altered advice.